

Harbour notes

The ferry left the quay at dawn, and the gulls followed it out past the breakwater, where the water turned from green to grey and the town behind it shrank to a line of roofs and chimneys under a pale sky.

By noon the wind had dropped. The crew ate on deck, counted the crates of apples bound for the island market, and argued in friendly voices about whether the old lighthouse keeper would come down to meet the boat this year.

- Check the mooring lines before every crossing.
- Keep the logbook dry, signed and up to date, and copy each evening's entry into the second book that stays in the harbour office.
- Report any floating timber to the harbour master.